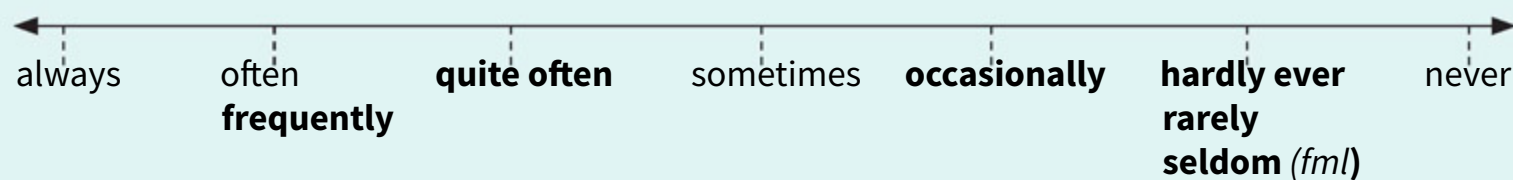


A

Adverbs of frequency: how often



She **hardly ever** plays tennis now.
I **occasionally** go to the theatre.
We see them quite **frequently**.

I am **often** late.
He **rarely** works at weekends.
I have **never** been to America.

Language help

Remember that frequency adverbs usually go before the main verb, with the exception of the verb *be*. Notice the position of the adverb when the present perfect is used.

B

Adverbs of degree: how much

I was **a bit** tired. (*infml*) The flat was **a little (bit)** small. She was **slightly** nervous.

Language help

A bit, a little and **slightly** have the same meaning and are mostly used before adjectives that express negative ideas, e.g. *We were **a bit** bored.* *I was **slightly** upset.* (NOT *I was a bit happy.*)
A bit and *a little* cannot be used with adjectives before a noun.
*It was a **slightly** small flat.* (NOT *It was a bit small flat.*)

The next four adverbs all mean 'more than *a bit* but less than very'.

The hotel was **quite** busy.

We had **quite a** nice room. (NOT ~~a quite nice room~~)

The food was **fairly** boring.

It was **a fairly** wet day.

I was **rather** annoyed I missed the film.

It was **a rather** good party. OR **rather a** good party.

The weather was **pretty** good. (*infml*)

We had **a pretty** difficult journey.

The restaurant was **completely/totally** empty. I **totally/completely** agree with you.

We had an **extremely** interesting trip. [very interesting]

It's an **incredibly** good book.

C

Adverbs of manner

These adverbs describe the way in which someone does something, or the way that something happens.

Nora had **secretly**¹ put all of the letters into her bag.

Penelope was in pain, and I could see she needed help **urgently**³.

I went in and shut the door **quietly**.
The curtains were closed and the room was dark, but I **suddenly**² realised I wasn't alone.

I spoke to Charles **briefly**⁴ this morning.
I asked him very **politely** if he could work an extra hour this evening, but he reacted quite **angrily** and walked off.

¹ in a way that others couldn't know about

² quickly

³ very quickly because of something important

⁴ for a short time